



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*chitvā saṃsṛtipāśam antarabalaṃ jitvātha mohādikaṃ dīkṣāṃ
mokṣakarīṃ prapadya sa budhaḥ pārśvaprabhor udyataḥ |
brahmajñānalayena kevalamayaṃ jñānaṃ samutpādyā ca prāyan
muktipadaṃ sadā sukhamayaṃ kṣīṇāṣṭakarmākrāmāt || 133 ||
ahiṃsā satyam asteyaṃ brahmacaryam asaṅgataḥ |
ity etāni vratāny atra saṃnyamaḥ pañcadhā smṛtaḥ || 134 ||*

— Yogapradīpa, Chapter 1, Verses 133-134

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

Liberation, the ultimate aim, is beautifully described in these verses. The wise individual, the "budha," diligently severs the bonds of worldly existence, that "saṃsṛtipāśa," that chain of suffering born from attachment and ignorance. This isn't a literal cutting, but a conscious dismantling of the illusions that bind you. It requires inner strength, "antarabalaṃ," to conquer delusions like attachment, aversion, and ignorance – those shadows that cloud your judgment and keep you tethered to the cycle of birth and death.

Initiation, "dīkṣāṃ," into a path that leads to liberation is then sought. This isn't merely a ceremony, but a profound commitment to self-transformation. It's choosing to actively cultivate wisdom and compassion. The enlightened one, empowered by this commitment, then dwells in the essence of Brahman, the ultimate reality, realizing the pure, undifferentiated knowledge, "kevalamayaṃ jñānaṃ." This is the awakening of your true nature, the realization that you are not separate from the divine.

Finally, shedding the eight karmas, the weighty burdens of past actions, the enlightened soul attains the state of liberation, "muktipadaṃ," a state of eternal bliss. This isn't a destination 'out there', but a state of being, accessible to you when you've purified your mind and heart.

Verse 134 outlines the five vows, "vratāni," which act as foundational restraints, "saṃnyamaḥ," on this path. These are ahiṃsā (non-violence), satyam (truthfulness), asteyaṃ (non-stealing), brahmacaryam (continence or right use of energy), and asaṅgataḥ (non-attachment). These are not just ethical guidelines; they are powerful tools for cultivating inner peace and freedom. They guide you towards harmonious living, both within yourself and in your relationships with the world around you. In modern life, practicing these vows means choosing compassion over judgment, honesty over deception, contentment over greed, mindful awareness over impulsive reactions, and freedom over clinging to the impermanent. These principles are not outdated; they are timeless keys to unlocking your potential for spiritual growth and lasting happiness.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

What one small shift could you make in your daily life to more fully embody one of the five vows, bringing you closer to inner peace and liberation?